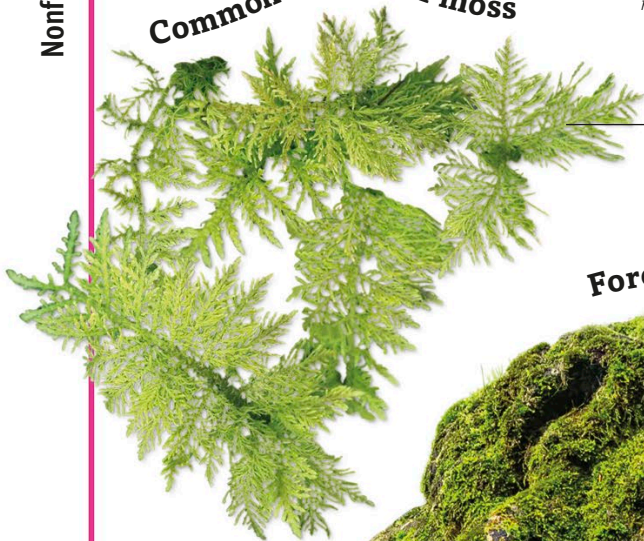




Ancient plants

The first animals lived in a world filled with plants, but this vegetation looked different to what we see around us today. The earliest dinosaurs would not have seen flowers, and the plant eaters would have chewed mosses and horsetails instead of grasses. Many of these ancient plants have disappeared, but some continue to thrive today.

Common tamarisk moss



Star-shaped shoots range from a yellow-green to a reddish brown color.

These feathery shoots look like tiny fern fronds.

Forest star moss



Spore-producing stems grow upright, allowing the spores to fly over a greater distance.

Twisted moss



Mosses absorb water and nutrients from rain and dust.

This tiny, leafy liverwort grows on damp soil.

Marsh clubmoss



Common kettlewort

Glossy shoots give this plant its name.



Glittering wood moss

